

Rural Entrepreneurship

Science

May, 2026



**SE
TU**

Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

Rural Entrepreneurship (A11412)

Short Title: Rural Entrepreneurship
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author RODOWD
Credits 5

Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

The aim of this module is to develop the student's critical awareness of the principles and techniques of rural entrepreneurship, and in particular to foster the student's skills in developing forestry- or agricultural-related enterprises, from concept stage to small business creation.

Programmes

ENTE-0007	BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)	4 / 8 / M
ENTE-0007	BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Forestry) (WD_SBSFO_B)	1 / 2 / E
ENTE-0007	BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Horticulture) (WD_SBSHO_B)	1 / 2 / E

Indicative Content

- The entrepreneurial process: profile of an entrepreneur; ontrapreneurship; small business ownership
- Idea generation; creativity and innovation strategies
- Establishing the enterprise: legal structures & start-up procedures; gaining a competitive advantage; mission statement & SWOT analysis
- Regulatory issues: taxation; accounting; insurance
- Management issues: choosing a location and premises; sources of finance; staffing issues
- Managing an enterprise: effective leadership; managerial decision making; motivation & learning; managing conflict
- The business plan: writing the plan; funding proposal; detailed projections; presenting the plan

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Evaluate the entrepreneurial process and discuss creativity and innovation strategies for small business creation.
2. Evaluate and discuss the necessary skills to develop and manage a successful small business.
3. Appraise and discuss the problems faced by small enterprises from sourcing finance to choosing a location for their business.
4. Design and write a successful business plan.
5. Evaluate motivation techniques and staffing decisions faced by entrepreneurs.
6. Critique theories of leadership and decision making in a small business context.
7. Evaluate how to establish an enterprise including legal structures, start-up procedures and regulatory issues.
8. Construct an effective pitch of the business idea.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Case studies.

- Class discussions.
- Videos.
- Guest speakers.
- Site visits.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>Case Studies</i>	40%	1,2,5,6
<i>Project</i>	40%	2,3,4,7
<i>Presentation</i>	20%	2,7,8

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Lacking in technical ability/skill and understanding to carry out practical/professional tasks. Failure to meet the objectives of projects. Unable to carry out or submit independent study and research.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. Show some technical ability/skill in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks. Attempt made to meet objectives and carry out independent study and research. Final result lacks balance and arguments undeveloped.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Logically and competently carry out practical/professional tasks. Satisfactory handling and awareness in carrying out independent study and research. Reporting and projects adequately structured and referenced.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrate sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically argue in an effective and mature style. Demonstrate initiative and the ability to criticise methods used and appreciation of experimental design when carrying out practical/professional tasks. Projects and reporting coherent and soundly structured illustrating wide and in depth reading on subject coupled with the proper use of references.
- 70%-100%:** Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject. Provide well focused analysis and convincing argument on the subject. Demonstrate imaginative approach, excellent technical ability, awareness, and aptitude in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks. Show initiative, individual thought, and enthusiasm in self study and independent learning.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- O'Hara, B. *Entrepreneurship in Ireland*. Dublin: Gill and Macmillan, 2011.